

INITIAL LANGUAGE EVALUATION REPORT

Laurianne Thoury

Candidate	Laurianne Thoury
Email	thoury@hec.fr
Department	The Sustainability & Organizations Center
Job Title	Head of Communications
Written Test Date	19 June 2026
Oral Session Date	22 June 2026
Evaluator	Hannah DURRANT
Report Date	22 June 2026

1. Executive Summary

Laurianne Thoury presents as a **confident, communicative and professionally motivated** user of English whose overall profile sits firmly at **B1+-B2 (2.5-3)** across the five assessed skill areas. Her results reflect a learner who is at or approaching the B2 threshold, with oral performance consistently stronger than written production — a profile that is well suited to her professional role and to a speaking-centred coaching programme.

| Overall CEFR Profile

Skill	CEFR Level	Score / Rating
Grammar	B1+ (2.5)	MCQ 25/30 — 83%
Reading / Vocabulary	B1+ (2.5)	Solid range; minor lexical precision gaps
Writing	B1+ (2.5)	Fluent and coherent; recurring surface errors
Listening	B2 (3)	Strong receptive performance in oral session
Speaking	B2 (3)	Confident delivery; natural fluency; minor lexical interference
Overall Operational Level	B1+-B2 (2.5-3)	Written: B1+ / Oral: B2

Laurianne's oral performance was notably stronger than her written test results might have suggested, confirming that surface-level errors in writing — many of which are attributable to French orthographic interference and processing speed — do not reflect

her real communicative capacity in spoken interaction. Her clarity of expression, good pronunciation and natural interactional instincts position her well for progress to a consolidated **B2 (3)** across all skills within the proposed training period.

2. Skill-by-Skill Assessment

| 2.1 Grammar — B1+ (2.5)

Strengths

- Consistent and correct deployment of the **present perfect** for ongoing situations and recent relevance (*"I have been working at HEC Paris for 14 years"*) — confirmed in both written and oral assessment, where she correctly identified and used this structure more than once.
- Confident production of **multi-clause and subordinate constructions**, demonstrating grammatical range beyond basic level.
- Appropriate and varied use of **modal and conditional forms** (*would, could*) for speculation, desire and hypothetical planning.
- Functional awareness of **passive constructions** and **temporal sequencing** in both narrative and professional registers.

Development Areas

- **Preposition accuracy:** The most frequent error pattern — *in/on* for geographical contexts (*"in the west coast"* → *on the west coast*), and *close by* vs. *close to* — requires targeted consolidation.
- **Article system:** Omission and misuse of the indefinite article before singular countable nouns (*"an occasion," "an 8-year-old son"*); definite article over-generalisation.
- **Gerund vs. infinitive alternation:** Specifically *be used to + gerund* (confused with *used to + infinitive*) and parallel infinitive structures in lists.
- **Tense backshift in subordinate clauses:** Past simple not consistently applied within past-tense narrative frames (*"before I go to University"* → *"before I went"*).
- **Tense confidence in spoken interaction:** Identified by the evaluator as a key gap — Laurianne occasionally hesitates or defaults to simpler tense forms when navigating more complex temporal relationships.
- **Spelling of French-cognate words:** Recurring misspellings (*professional, personal, environment, occasionally, rhythm, childhood*) reflect French orthographic interference rather than systemic gaps, but merit focused attention.

| 2.2 Reading and Vocabulary — B1+ (2.5)

Strengths

- **Active vocabulary range** comfortably exceeds basic level; purposeful and contextually appropriate lexical choices across all three written responses.
- Demonstrated awareness of **stylistic register**, moving between personal narrative, professional description and aspirational discourse.
- Strong **idiomatic awareness** in places ("*at my own pace*," "*explore wild lands*"), suggesting meaningful exposure to authentic English.
- MCQ performance at **83%** confirms solid reading comprehension and reliable vocabulary recognition at B1+, with partial mastery of B2-level lexical items in context.

Development Areas

- **Collocation accuracy**: Verb-noun collocations calqued from French ("*do a Tour de France*" → "*go on a road trip around France*"; "*Grand Travel*" → "*a long journey / an extended trip*") require targeted replacement with idiomatic English alternatives.
- **Lexical precision under ambiguity**: Occasional semantic imprecision ("*I feel that I work a lot between my professional work and my personal life*") suggests that B2-level vocabulary consolidation — particularly around abstract professional concepts such as work-life balance, communication and strategy — will be of direct benefit.
- **Natural expressions and fixed phrases**: Identified by the evaluator as a development priority — building a working repertoire of natural conversational and professional expressions to replace direct French-influenced constructions.

| 2.3 Writing — B1+ (2.5)

Strengths

- **Communicative fluency**: All three written responses are coherent, logically structured and fully intelligible. Laurianne does not avoid complex ideas or resort to formulaic language.
- **Discourse organisation**: Consistent use of logical sequencing, appropriate connectors (*before, also, of course, as*) and paragraph awareness — skills directly transferable to professional writing tasks.
- **Narrative competence**: The hometown response is notably the strongest piece, demonstrating elegant sentence construction ("*I had everything that a child needs: love, nature and security*"), varied syntax and emotional authenticity. This response was assessed at **B2 (3)** in isolation.
- **Register awareness**: Writing reflects appropriate self-presentation and professional contextualisation, with a confident, individual voice throughout.

Development Areas

- Surface-level errors across all responses (detailed under Grammar, §2.1) remain the primary limitation — none impede communication, but their frequency and patterning place the overall written level at B1+ rather than B2.

- **Reliance on AI tools for spelling and grammar checking** (noted in the professional context) may be limiting the development of autonomous proofreading habits and self-correction strategies. Addressing deep writing accuracy within a 10-hour programme is acknowledged as a secondary priority; however, building **self-editing awareness** is recommended as a light-touch component of sessions.
- **Advanced future forms:** B2-level structures (*future continuous, future perfect*) are not yet deployed in free writing, limiting the expressive range available for planning and projection tasks.

| 2.4 Listening — B2 (3)

Strengths

- Laurianne demonstrated **strong receptive performance** throughout the oral session, tracking the evaluator's questions and contributions accurately without requests for repetition.
- Her responses were consistently **relevant and well-calibrated** to the input she received, confirming that her listening comprehension comfortably supports professional interaction in English.
- Able to follow **natural speech at normal pace**, including when the evaluator introduced idiomatic expressions and multi-part questions.

Development Areas

- No significant gaps were identified at this level. Continued exposure to **authentic professional English** — meetings, presentations, podcast content in her field — is recommended to consolidate B2 listening and build passive vocabulary in sustainability and institutional communication contexts.

| 2.5 Speaking — B2 (3)

Strengths

- **Fluency:** Notably confident and natural — Laurianne speaks without excessive hesitation and maintains communicative momentum across a range of topics.
- **Pronunciation:** Clear and intelligible, with good stress and rhythm patterns. Identified by the evaluator as a distinct strength.
- **Interaction:** Engaged and responsive; demonstrates the interactional instincts of a communicative learner comfortable with discussion and exchange.
- **Accuracy:** Good — grammatical errors in spoken production are broadly consistent with written gaps but do not disrupt communication.
- **Oral performance exceeded written test expectations:** The evaluator noted that Laurianne's spoken English was stronger than anticipated from the written assessment alone — a significant positive finding.

Development Areas

- **Vocabulary range:** Assessed as *developing* — Laurianne has good general vocabulary but her productive lexical range in professional and technical English contexts is not yet fully consolidated at B2 level. The evaluator noted a tendency to **import French expressions directly into English** ("*a calm weekend*," "*a presential class*"), which occasionally produces non-idiomatic or opaque formulations.
- **Confidence with tenses in real time:** Identified as a key gap — under the pressure of live interaction, Laurianne occasionally defaults to simpler or less precise tense structures, particularly when narrating past sequences or projecting into the future.
- **Meeting language and small talk:** Specific functional gaps in the language of professional meetings (turn-taking, agreeing/disagreeing diplomatically, signposting) and informal collegiate conversation — priority areas directly aligned with her stated learning goals.
- The evaluator noted that a rating of **B2- would have been appropriate** for oral expression had that option been available, suggesting that while the B2 threshold is reached, it is not yet consistently consolidated across all speaking contexts.

3. Learning Objectives

The following three objectives are sequenced according to **Bloom's Taxonomy**, progressing from knowledge consolidation through applied professional performance to higher-order communicative autonomy. They are grounded in Laurianne's validated goals, her evaluator-identified strengths and gaps, and her professional context as Head of Communications in an international academic environment.

| Objective 1 — Remember / Understand *(Knowledge & Comprehension)*

> **By the end of the programme, Laurianne will be able to identify and self-correct her most frequent grammatical and lexical patterns** — including tense confidence, preposition accuracy and French-influenced expressions — by applying targeted self-monitoring strategies during both planned and spontaneous spoken production.

This objective addresses the evaluator's identified key gaps (tense confidence, natural expressions, French interference) through recognition tasks, reformulation exercises and structured reflection activities embedded in professional vocabulary. Rather than treating grammar in isolation, consolidation will be achieved through contextualised input drawn from her working environment — sustainability communication, institutional presentation language and meeting discourse. Given that Laurianne uses AI tools to check her writing, this objective also develops **autonomous self-editing awareness** as a transferable professional skill.

| Objective 2 — Apply / Analyse *(Application & Analysis)*

> **By the end of the programme, Laurianne will be able to construct and deliver a structured professional pitch in English — confidently introducing herself, her role, her department's mission and its key activities — and to participate actively* in professional meetings and team conversations, using appropriate register, meeting language conventions and small talk strategies.*

This objective directly addresses her four confirmed professional goals: self-presentation, role and institution description, strategic pitching, and participation in meetings. It builds on her existing strengths in narrative organisation, fluency and pronunciation, while targeting the specific functional areas identified by the evaluator as priorities: **meeting language, small talk with international colleagues, and role-play scenarios**. Sessions will be structured around communicative tasks — simulated meetings, pitch rehearsals, colleague conversations — reflecting her profile as a learner who is *communicative and will enjoy role plays and discussion*.

| Objective 3 — Evaluate / Create *(Synthesis & Higher-Order Production)*

> **By the end of the programme, Laurianne will be able to respond fluently and strategically to unexpected, challenging or destabilising questions during professional presentations*, using hedging language, clarification techniques and reformulation strategies to maintain composure, credibility and communicative authority in English.*

This objective directly targets her validated goal — *"répondre avec aisance à des questions déstabilisantes lors d'une présentation orale"* — and represents the highest level of communicative performance within the programme. It requires the integration of all consolidated grammar, vocabulary, discourse and interactional skills under realistic communicative pressure. Achieving this objective will transform Laurianne's current B2-level oral competence into genuinely professional-grade confidence — the ability not merely to present, but to **hold the room** in English.

4. Training Plan

| 4.1 Programme Overview

Parameter	Detail
Current Level	B1+–B2 (2.5–3) — Written: B1+ / Oral: B2

Target Level	B2 (3) — consolidated across all skills
Total Coached Hours	10 hours
Recommended Self-Study	5 hours (15-20 minutes between sessions)
Programme Format	Individual coaching — video call (visio)
Session Rhythm	1 × 60-minute session per week

4.2 Priority Content Areas

The following content areas are sequenced to reflect the evaluator's stated learning priorities and Laurianne's confirmed professional context. Given the compact 10-hour programme, focus is maintained on **oral professional performance**, with grammar and vocabulary development embedded within communicative tasks rather than delivered in isolation.

Priority	Content Area	Rationale
1 — Core	Small talk and general conversation for colleagues	Evaluator-identified priority; directly supports her international team context
2 — Core	Meeting language: participation, turn-taking, agreeing and disagreeing	Validated goal; addresses confidence gap in meeting situations
3 — Core	Role-play situations: professional scenarios, Q&A management	Suits her communicative learner profile; addresses destabilising questions goal
4 — Core	Self-presentation and professional pitch delivery	Validated goal; builds on existing narrative and fluency strengths
5 — Supporting	Tense confidence in spoken interaction	Evaluator-identified key gap; integrated within role-play and discussion tasks
6 — Supporting	Natural expressions and idiomatic collocations	Addresses French interference and vocabulary development rating
7 — Light-touch	Self-editing awareness for writing	AI dependency noted; brief reflection activities rather than extended written tasks

4.3 Suggested Session Arc (10 Hours)

Sessions	Focus
1-2	Needs audit and rapport; self-presentation in professional contexts; tense review in spoken

	narratives
3-4	Meeting language: structured participation, signposting, agreeing and challenging diplomatically
5-6	Small talk with colleagues; natural expressions; replacing French-influenced collocations
7-8	Pitch preparation and delivery: mission, team, institution; structured feedback and reformulation
9	Q&A and destabilising questions: hedging, clarification, strategic reformulation under pressure
10	Full simulated professional scenario (meeting + pitch + Q&A); evaluative feedback and programme review

4.4 Confirmed Scheduling

Parameter	Detail
Preferred Session Slot	Friday lunchtime — 12:00–14:00 *(candidate at home; preferred option)*
Confirmed Available Slots	Monday evening / Tuesday 12:00–14:00 / Wednesday afternoon / Thursday 12:00–14:00 / Friday 12:00–14:00
Scheduling Note	Friday lunchtime is the candidate's stated preference and should be prioritised for session scheduling. Alternative slots confirmed as available if required.
Format	Video call (visio)

5. Evaluator Narrative Summary

Laurianne Thoury is a **poised, articulate and professionally grounded** learner whose English profile reflects both the strengths and the characteristic development areas of a highly educated French-speaking professional operating confidently at the upper B1–lower B2 threshold. Her written test performance (B1+, 83% MCQ) provides a reliable map of her grammatical awareness, while the oral session confirmed what the written evidence suggested but could not demonstrate: that Laurianne communicates in English with **genuine fluency, clarity and natural interactional confidence** that place her spoken performance at a solid B2 level.

The contrast between written and oral performance is instructive. In writing, surface errors — predominantly French orthographic interference, article omission and

preposition inaccuracies — create a somewhat noisy picture that does not fully reflect her communicative capacity. In speech, these patterns recede, and what emerges is a speaker who holds her own in professional interaction, tracks conversation accurately, and responds with a voice that is both clear and credible. The evaluator's candid note — that a B2- rating for oral expression might have been more precise — is a fair and useful calibration: Laurianne has crossed the B2 threshold, but has not yet consolidated it uniformly across all spoken contexts, particularly under the pressure of unexpected questions or complex tense navigation in real time.

Her professional context is highly relevant to programme design. As Head of Communications in an international academic centre, Laurianne produces video and text content, uses AI tools to support her writing, participates in meetings with international colleagues, and represents her institution in presentations and strategic communications. She is not a learner who needs to build English from the ground up — she needs to **refine, consolidate and professionalise** what she already has. The evaluator's learning priority notes are clear and well-calibrated: the emphasis should be on **small talk and collegiate conversation, meeting language, and role-play scenarios**, with grammar addressed lightly and contextually rather than as a separate strand.

It is worth noting the evaluator's observation regarding AI tool dependency. While Laurianne's use of AI to check spelling and grammar is pragmatic and professionally appropriate, it may be inadvertently limiting the development of autonomous self-correction habits. A brief, non-burdensome **self-monitoring strand** embedded within sessions — encouraging Laurianne to notice and reformulate her own productions rather than outsource that function — would serve her well in contexts where AI assistance is not available: live meetings, spontaneous presentations, and precisely the high-stakes Q&A situations that form the core of her third learning objective.

Laurianne brings **excellent raw material** to this programme: communicative drive, professional self-awareness, strong pronunciation, and the kind of narrative intelligence that makes presentation coaching genuinely productive. The evaluator's closing remark — that "*Laurianne will be an asset to any group*" — speaks not only to her linguistic profile but to the quality of learner she represents. With a focused 10-hour coaching programme centred on professional oral performance, and a recommended self-study component of 5 hours, there is every reason to expect that she will achieve a **consolidated B2 (3)** across all five skills within the programme period, and be fully equipped to represent herself, her team and her institution in English with confidence and authority.

6. Sign-Off

This Final English Language Evaluation Report has been prepared by Linguaid France on the basis of a written placement test administered on 19 June 2026 and an oral assessment conducted on 22 June 2026. Results reflect the candidate's performance at

the time of assessment and are intended to inform programme design and placement decisions.

Evaluator	Hannah DURRANT
Organisation	Linguaid France
Written Test Date	19 June 2026
Oral Assessment Date	22 June 2026
Report Issued	22 June 2026
Candidate	Laurianne Thoury — Head of Communications, The Sustainability & Organizations Center, HEC Paris
Overall Level at Assessment	B1+–B2 (Written: B1+ / Oral: B2)
Target Level	B2 (3)
Programme	10 coached hours + 5 self-study hours — Individual video coaching

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